

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE SEED – John 12:23-26

In this reflection we are going to focus on

1. The significance of Jesus speaking about himself and how he, as the only son of God, through his being planted and dying, would produce many other sons and daughters.

*Romans 8:29 For God knew his people in advance, and he chose them to become like his Son, so that his Son would be **the firstborn among many brothers and sisters**. NLT*

*Hebrews 2:10 For it was fitting, **in bringing many sons to glory**, that He, for whom and through whom all things exist, should make the source of their salvation perfect through sufferings. Holman Christian*

2. And about us making a deliberate choice to follow Christ's example by applying the same principles of his coming down (humility), his being planted (giving his life to this world), his dying (to his own will), and his remaining planted so that he would produce a harvest of new lives.

THE PRINCIPLES OF CHRIST'S EXAMPLE ARE ALSO OURS TO IMITATE.

John 12:23-26

*23 Jesus replied that the time had come for him to return to his glory in heaven, and that "I **must FALL and DIE** like a kernel of wheat that falls into the furrows of the earth. **UNLESS I DIE** I will be alone—a single seed. **But my death will produce many new wheat kernels—a plentiful harvest of new lives.***

25 If you love your life down here—you will lose it. If you despise your life down here—you will exchange it for eternal glory.

*26 "If these Greeks want to be my disciples, tell them to come and follow me, for my servants must be where I am. **And if they follow me**, the Father will honor them. TLB*

JESUS WAS THAT SEED WHICH FELL DOWN (humility) INTO THE GROUND AND DIED AND PRODUCED A HARVEST OF MANY NEW LIVES (seeds).

THIS IS JESUS' STORY.

- **ABOUT HIS FALLING DOWN** – it was not accidental but **HIS DELIBERATE CHOICE.**
- **ABOUT HIS DYING** - being planted in his father's will – to bring salvation and redemption to all peoples.
- **ABOUT HIS REMAINING PLANTED** – remaining in that state of faithfulness and commitment to the father's will and the commission given him.
- **ABOUT HIS DELIBERATE ACTION AND THE RESULTING EFFECTS** of producing many new seeds/ lives.
- **ABOUT HIS DECISIVE ACTION** taken – knowingly the cost and the price.
- **ABOUT HIS WILLINGNESS TO DIE** to his plans, aspirations and desires and **EXCHANGE** them for the Father's will **FOR HIM.**

- ABOUT HIS MEETING ALL CONDITIONS REQUIRED OF HIM.
- IT IS ABOUT OUR PREPAREDNESS TO MOVE FROM OUR NORMAL POSITION OF THINKING AND REASONING THAT WE ARE ACCUSTOMED TO AND FULLY EMBRACING A NEW SENSE OF READINESS SPIRITUALLY, EMOTIONALLY, PHYSICALLY, AND CULTURALLY.
- OUR FALLING DOWN AND BEING PLANTED IN GOD'S WILL IS NOT THE RESULT OF AN ACCIDENT
- OR THE RESULT OF PREVAILING CIRCUMSTANCES OR PEER PRESSURE
- OR THE RESULT OF CHANCE, LUCK OR SOME 'KARMA'
- IT IS TO BE THE RESULT OF DELIBERATE CHOICE AND DECISIVE ACTION.
- IT'S ABOUT OUR WILLINGNESS TO LAY ASIDE OUR IDEAS, OUR PREVIOUSLY HELD VIEWS OF CHRIST'S GREAT COMMISSION AND DOING ALL WE CAN TO OBEY IN EVERY ASPECT.
- IT'S ABOUT US 'COMING DOWN' FROM OUR PRECONCEIVED IDEAS, PREFERENCES AND PREJUDICES AND MAKE A DETERMINED EFFORT TO EMBRACE ALL PEOPLES.
- IT'S ABOUT OUR READINESS TO 'HUMBLE OURSELVES' AND BE PLANTED IN THE WILL OF GOD.
- IT'S ABOUT OUR BEING PREPARED TO 'COME DOWN', HUMBLE OURSELVES, TO 'STOOP DOWN' TO THOSE PEOPLE WHO ARE IN NEED SO THAT WE CAN LIFT THEM UP.
- IT'S ABOUT US CONTINUING 'TO DO GOOD', ALWAYS SHOWING COMPASSION, MERCY AND ACCEPTANCE TO ALL PEOPLES.
- IT'S ABOUT OUR LOVING OUR LIVES LESS AND LOVING GOD'S WILL MORE.
- IT'S ABOUT OUR MULTIPLYING AND REPRODUCING OURSELVES - WHERE WE OUR ONE LIFE PLANTED, BURIED, PRODUCES MANY NEW LIVES.

AS IT WAS WITH JESUS – SO IT IS ALSO WITH US

THE CONDITIONS - THERE IS THE 'UNLESS'

UNLESS I DIE - *I will be alone-a single seed. But my death will produce many new wheat kernels-a plentiful harvest of new lives.*

- **UNLESS** WE ALSO ARE PREPARED TO DIE TO SELF-INTERESTS – DESIRES AND ASPIRATIONS THAT WE HAVE FOR OUR LIVES **AND** BE PLANTED IN THE FATHER'S WILL THERE WILL BE NO FRUITFULNESS, NO REPRODUCTION OF OUR LIVES.
- OUR LIFE (A SINGLE SEED) WILL NOT PRODUCE ANYTHING MORE UNLESS IT DIES TO SELF-INTERESTS AND REMAINS PLANTED IN GOD'S WILL AND PURPOSES. THERE WILL BE NO MULTIPLICATION OF OURSELVES IN THE WAY THAT GOD REFERS TO IT.
- FRUITFULNESS AND MULTIPLICATION OF THE SEED SO THAT IT PRODUCES MANY SEEDS IS DEPENDENT ON REMAINING PLANTED, BURIED IN GOD'S WILL.

QUESTIONS TO BE ASKED

- Are we willing to die to our plans and exchange it for God's plans for our lives?
- Are we willing to plant ourselves in a location and amongst a people that he has chosen for us?
- Are we willing to walk in those paths that God had before ordained and prepared for us?
Ephesians 2:10 For we are His creation—created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared ahead of time so that we should walk in them. Holman Bible
- Are we willing to stay planted, stay the distance, remain engaged in the mission until completed?
- Are we willing to follow in the footsteps that Jesus set for us?

1 Peter 2:21 "...For Christ also suffered for you, leaving you [His personal] example, so that you should follow in His footsteps". AMP

Amen - Pastor Barry